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Submitter Information

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General Comment

To the US Federal Government Review board or whomsoever is charged with reading these responses, I am a concerned citizen writing to you to ask that you deny Google and OpenAI's request to train their Large Language Models or other similar technologies on copyrighted content. The technologies they are trying to improve are assemblages of mathematical formulae that attempt to predict trends and patterns. It is the belief of this citizen that allowing Google and OpenAI to scrape copyrighted data will not result in worthwhile product for the USA and thus should be denied.

Currently most self-styled "AI-models" do not have a viable use case outside of tech demonstrations. They can feed novel stimuli into their models to output the appearance of new and interesting things like speech, prose, art, music and so on. Kindly remember that these machines are running elaborate equations to anticipate trends and patterns in previous information. The machine is recreating material it has already seen just like Pavlov and his dogs. Whether or not the response is appropriate or correct for the given stimuli is not considered by the machine as it parrots out its response. Since it cannot produce new things or things to fit a situation it cannot add to a situation any solutions or insights that aren't already apparent or available.

Already there are many reports of people receiving awful and inappropriate answers from these models. All from information scraped off the internet wholesale. Information that is riddled with in-jokes, slang, and cultural references from thousands of users which are the cause of these off-kilter responses. All of which is spat back out without consideration of the context of the original text and source which may very well be a discussion thread for a video game, movie or novel that may not reflect our day-to-day reality. If the discourse around these properties is so beset with unintelligible "answers" and "insights" can it really be said that including the source material will result in more appropriate answers?

The answer is no! As already mentioned above these are sophisticated prediction machines. They do not process information like the human mind does and consider context, source and intent. These machines find the very next word, pixel, vibration in each medium through an elaborate mathematical process and spit it back without care or concern for whatever the question, request or command was. The question that should be asked now that we have established the nature of this technology is whether or not allowing this request to be approved will provide more benefit than the costs. Is there any long-term value in allowing these two companies wholesale access to copyrighted works? Debatable.

Is there potential for enormous damage when these companies' machines use that same data to produce off-kilter irrelevant responses that are not novel innovations or sensitive solutions to new scenarios? Unquestionably yes.

Is copyright law not in place to incentivize and protect innovators, creatives and entrepreneurs in their respective endeavors? To grease the wheel of progress to ask people to pursue new ideas and modes of thinking to create wonderful things: Inventions to solve problems, media to enrich our lives, systems of commerce to better distribute resources to more people.

I assert that it would be foolish to allow these companies access to this information. Irrespective of their good intentions or otherwise. They represent the dissolution of our entire system of intellectual property. Allowing them to peruse all protected works and ideas will galvanize their peers and competitors in this arena and beyond to clamor for the same in the name of business and profits. It would lead to the complete degradation and then disregard of the copyright system.

The projected infinite wealth of the future squandered to allow two companies an attempt at a competition with their foreign counterparts. The future wasted upon a barbarous "arm wrestling" competition that has made nobody money abroad or domestically. The choice seems blindingly simple: do not allow them access.